

Jinil Kim

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RESEARCH INTEREST

- Developing computational frameworks that extract latent signatures from human brain and behavior
- Translating these into real-world systems for personalized interventions and human-inspired AI
- Uncovering shared and distinct principles across brains, machines, and languages

EDUCATION

Seoul National University

B.A. Linguistics · B.A. Psychology · B.S. Computer Science

GPA: 4.18 / 4.3 (3.97 / 4.0)

* Mandatory military service, Jul 2023 – Jan 2025

Seoul, South Korea

Mar 2021 – Exp. Feb 2027

The University of Hong Kong

Summer Research Program, Faculty of Psychology

Hong Kong SAR

Jun 2025 – Aug 2025

PUBLICATIONS & MANUSCRIPTS

Workshop Papers

- **Kim, J.**, Cho, A. M., Seo, J., & Cha, J. (2026). *Inferring Individualized Color-Vision Distortions from fMRI Hue-Representation Geometry*. ICML 2026 Workshop on Structured Data for Health, Seoul, Korea.

Under Review

- **Kim, J.**, Jeong, J., Yun, H., Oh, M.-H., & Ahn, W.-Y. *Inverse reinforcement learning of latent human planning*. Under review at NeurIPS.
- **Kim, J.**, & Ryu, J. *Conversational relevance in the conjunction fallacy is represented independently in language models*. Under review at the NeurIPS 2026 Workshop on Linguistic Principles for Foundation Models (LP4FM).

In Preparation

- **Kim, J.**, Cho, A. M., Seo, J., & Cha, J. *Preserved categorical identification with impaired hue interpolation in color vision deficiency motivates a cortically derived correction filter*.
- **Kim, J.**, & Yao, Y.-W. *Depression relates to when, and not only how strongly, information enters a social decision*.

PRESENTATIONS

- **Kim, J.**, Cho, M., Seo, J., & Cha, J. (2026). *fMRI Decoding Reveals Intact Neural Color Representations in Color Vision Deficiency*. OHBM 2026 Annual Meeting, Bordeaux, France. [Poster]
- **Kim, J.**, & Yao, Y.-W. (2025). *When, not just how strongly: a delayed onset of attribute integration in depression*. HKU Summer Research Program, Hong Kong. [Poster]

RESEARCH PROJECTS

Preserved categorical identification with impaired hue interpolation in color vision deficiency motivates a cortically derived correction filter

Project Lead, sole first author (Advisor: Prof. Jiook Cha)

Apr 2025 – Present

- Characterized individual-specific distortions of cortical hue geometry in color vision deficiency from fMRI, and translated them into personalized color-correction filters.
- Funded by the SNU Undergraduate Research Grant (\$3,500).

Depression relates to when, and not only how strongly, information enters a social decision

Project Lead, sole first author (Advisor: Prof. Yuan-Wei Yao)

Jun 2025 – Present

- Built a time-varying drift-diffusion model with an onset-latency parameter (τ) showing that depression integrates the second decision attribute later in social decisions.

Inverse Reinforcement Learning of Latent Human Planning

Project Lead, sole first author (Advisor: Prof. Woo-Young Ahn)

Sep 2025 – Present

- Developing an inverse reinforcement learning framework that more faithfully models human decision-making while recovering latent planning depth from behavior alone.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Connectome Lab

Undergraduate RA (Advisor: Prof. Jiook Cha)

Research area: Brain foundation models; neural fields

Seoul National University

Jul 2026 – Present

Computational Clinical Science Lab

Undergraduate RA (Advisor: Prof. Woo-Young Ahn)

Research area: Inverse RL; computational psychiatry; multimodal digital phenotyping

Seoul National University

Apr 2025 – Present

Mental health, Internet, Neuroscience & Decision-making (MIND) Lab

Visiting Researcher (Advisor: Prof. Yuan-Wei Yao)

Research area: Computational modeling of social decision-making

University of Hong Kong

Jun 2025 – Aug 2025

SCHOLARSHIPS & FELLOWSHIPS

KOSAF Humanity 100 Years Undergraduate Scholarship

Amount: \$12,500

Mar 2025 – Jul 2026

SNU Undergraduate Research Grant

Amount: \$3,500

Apr 2025

The University of Hong Kong Foundation for Educational Development and Research Scholarship

Amount: \$1,300

Jun 2025 – Aug 2025

Superior Academic Performance Scholarship

Amount: \$1,650 each

Mar 2022, 2023; Sep 2022

HONORS & AWARDS

Best Poster Award, SNU Undergraduate Research Program

SNU Student-Proposed Liberal Arts Course Contest (1st Place)

Jan 2026

Jul 2023

TEACHING

Teaching Assistant, Basic Computing

English (Mar 2026) · Korean (Sep 2025)

Seoul National University

LANGUAGES

Human: Korean (Native), English (Full Professional Proficiency), French (Beginner)

Programming: Python, R, Stan, C++, Java